SHORE CONFERENCE OF HIGH SCHOOLS SOCCER CHAMPIONSHIPS-2026

SPORT Boys and Girls Soccer

Tournament Directors - Josh Mehl- Freehold Township High School

Ted Gillen- Toms River High Schools

Assistant Tournament Directors- Natalie Gorman- Ranney School

Assistant Tournament Director- Chris Provow- Manalapan High School

PROPOSED DATE(S): SCT Soccer CHAMPIONSHIP Bracket - cut off - 10/10/26- COMPLETE all group games before 6:00 pm on 10/10/26 (Saturday)

General Rules and Regulations

1). All games will be governed by the National Federation Soccer Rules with NJSIAA and Shore Conference modifications.

2). All Shore Conference schools will be in either the Championship bracket or the Coaches Bracket, unless the schools opted out of the tournament.

Please note Shore Conference Rule 22…

RULE 22

(Shore Conference Tournament Seeding Procedures)

A. A varsity team accumulating a total of (3) or more disqualifications, inclusive of player and/or coach, for flagrant or unsportsmanlike conduct prior to the start of a Conference tournament shall not be eligible to participate in the tournament. Seeded teams will forfeit their right to compete if a disqualification limit is reached prior to the start of the tournament. Once the Conference tournament begins, a team's total disqualifications shall reset to zero (0) and in the event any team accumulates a total of (3) or more disqualifications, inclusive of player and/or coach, for flagrant or unsportsmanlike conduct during the tournament the Executive Committee reserves the right to review the disqualifications and determine if that team may continue to participate in the tournament or be removed from the tournament. The disqualification rule for tournament eligibility and the Executive Committee's continued tournament eligibility decisions are non-appealable and not subject to the filing of a protest.

3). The tournament will consist of one ***championship bracket*** of teams that win their world cup grouping/come in 2nd or 3rd in their group, and one ***coaches bracket*** with the rest of the teams from the conference. The winners will be determined based on single elimination in the championship/coaches brackets. 24 total girls teams, 24 total boys teams, will make the Shore Conference Championship bracket, and all other schools will be invited to participate in the

Coaches Cup bracket. All Shore Conference member schools shall participate in this tournament unless they file with the conference secretary before the official seeding meeting.

4). All officials for the SCT games shall be selected by the Tournament Director/Soccer Assignor in conjunction with the **S**hore **S**occer **O**fficials **A**ssociation.

5) All teams must adhere to Rule 14 Section 7 of the sport regulations regarding maximum games (NJSIAA Constitution, Bylaws, Rules & Regulations). Any team that cannot complete the tournament (thru the final game) because of total number of games/scrimmages will not be selected for participation in the tournament. (All tournament games including consolations do not count in the maximum number of games).

6) Home teams determine the game times, if schools mutually agree to play before the scheduled date and it can be accommodated by the assignor, that is allowed.

7) All games within both tournaments are Seeded by the committee.
Group winners will receive byes, and based on the number of teams in the Coaches Cup byes will be determined accordingly. The entire schedule will be shared with Athletic Directors and Coaches ahead of time.

SCHOOLS ENTERING THE TOURNAMENT WILL NOT BE GRANTED A CHANGE OF DATE DUE TO ANY CONFLICTS WITH SCHOOL TRIP, DANCES, BANQUETS, TESTING PROGRAMS AND THE LIKE.

FIELD SITES
1). Sites for the first three rounds will be at the field of the higher seeded team as determined by the seeding.
2). If any game must be rescheduled because of weather and the home team's field is not playable, the game will be played at the opposing team's field and the tournament director must be notified. If that field is not playable a neutral site must be secured. **Please note*** any game during the tournament that is interrupted by inclement weather will resume at the point of interruption. This is a State postseason rule.**
3). The Championship bracket **Semifinals for the GIRLS** will be held at Summerfield School Athletic Field on 10/21/26, games will be at (Lower bracket (#2 seed bracket)- 4:00pm) & (Upper bracket (#1 seed bracket)- 6:30 p.m.).
4). The Championship Bracket **Semifinals for the BOYS** will be held at Summerfield School Athletic Field on 10/22/26, games will be at 4:00p.m. (Lower bracket) and 6:30 pm (Upper Bracket).

5). Championship games will be played at Summerfield School Athletic Field. Finals are on 10/24/26 - see schedule below for times.

10am- Girls Coaches Cup Final

1230pm- Boys Coaches Cup Final

300pm- Girls SCT Finals

600pm- Boys SCT Finals

Rain date - Sunday, 10/25/26

6) All winner's bracket games for the Coaches Tournament will be held at the higher seed until the finals, which will be held at the Summerfield School in Neptune (see schedule). The Home team shall be responsible for paying for officials until the finals.
7**).** Responsibility for postponing a game shall rest with the person in charge of the playing sites and it shall be his responsibility to notify both schools and the tournament directors at least two hours prior to each game.
*****If the Semi-Finals are delayed by weather, girls will play on Thursday and the boys will play on Friday. The finals will remain on Saturday unless weather delays them on that day.**

GAMES
a). Starting time for the first three round(s) shall be no later than 3:00 pm unless the field has. Lights.
b). If rain delays the completion of a round, teams must adhere to the deadline of the succeeding round even though those games must be played on consecutive days.
c). Referees may move a contest interrupted by darkness, to a field with lights, to complete the game.
d). The home team will wear dark jerseys throughout the tournament.
"The visiting team must bring both jerseys to each round of play".
The higher seeded team will be the home team in the semi-finals and the championship game.
e). Schools may use walkie-talkie or other communication equipment so long as they provide all of their own equipment.
f). The game shall consist of two forty-minute halves. Any game stopped due to weather shall resume at the point of interruption. If rain delays the completion of a round, teams must adhere to the deadline of the succeeding game and games tied shall be resumed from the point of interruption.
h.) **TIE GAME PROCEDURE**
There shall be up to two (2), ten (10)-minute "sudden victory" overtime periods.
(a) a coin toss shall be held as in Rule 5-2-2(E).
(b) Teams shall change ends if a second overtime period is required.
(c.) There shall be a two (2)-minute interval between periods.

IF THE SCORE REMAINS TIED AFTER TWO OVERTIME PERIODS OF SUDDEN VICTORY A SHOOTOUT SHALL OCCUR:

(a) The referee designates which captain will call the coin toss and which goal is to be used.
(b). The team winning the coin toss has the choice of shooting first or second.
(c). Each coach will select five players, on or off the field, (except those disqualified) to take penalty kicks.
(d). The teams will alternate kickers with the goalkeeper being an eligible team member.
(e). The team scoring the greater number of kicks shall advance. There is no follow-up on the kick.
(f). The kicks shall end at the point where the advancing team has been determined.
(g). The defending team may change the goalkeeper prior to each kick.
(h). Repeat the same procedure as in (B) above. Any or all of the same players may or may not be used again when repeating the procedure of (B) above, a winner must be declared if a team scores, and the opponent fails to score.

MEDIA

The winning team is responsible for notifying the Asbury Park Press, Shore Sports Network, Star Ledger, and any other news service in the area.

OFFICIALS

In the first three rounds of the Shore Conference Tournament, it is the responsibility of the home team to schedule and pay the officials. If both teams agree, the home team will pay for the third official in the quarterfinal round of play. The Shore Conference shall pay the officials in the semi-final round and the championship games of the Championship brackets and the finals for the coach brackets.

PROPOSED DATE(S): SCT Soccer CHAMPIONSHIP Bracket & Coaches Cup Bracket

1Cut off for qualification 10/10/26

2. Round #1 SCT and Coaches Cup Girls on 10/13
3. Round #1 SCT and Coaches Cup Boys on 10/14
4. Round #2 SCT and Coaches Cup/consolation games Girls on 10/15
5. Round #2 SCT and Coaches Cup/consolation games Boys on 10/16
6. Rain Date for make ups 10/17
7. SCT and Coaches Cup Quarterfinals/Consolations for Girls 10/19
8. SCT and Coaches Cup Quarterfinals/Consolations for Boys 10/20
9. SCT and Coaches Cup Semifinals/Consolations for Girls 10/21
10. SCT and Coaches Cup Semifinals/Consolations for Boys 10/22
12. SCT and Coaches Cup Finals on 10/24

13. Rain Date 10/25

**********Changes

1. Cut off for qualification 10/10/26
2. Round #1 SCT and Coaches Cup Girls on 10/13
3. Round #1 SCT and Coaches Cup Boys on 10/14
4. Round #2 SCT and Coaches Cup/consolation games Girls on 10/15
5. Round #2 SCT and Coaches Cup/consolation games Boys on 10/16
6. SCT and Coaches Cup Quarterfinals/Consolations for Girls 10/17
7. SCT and Coaches Cup Quarterfinals/Consolations for Boys 10/19
8. SCT and Coaches Cup Semifinals/Consolations for Girls 10/20
9. SCT and Coaches Cup Semifinals/Consolations for Boys 10/21
10. SCT and Coaches Cup Finals on 10/24

PROPOSED SITE(S) & TIME(S):

- Preliminary Rounds are at the Higher Seed and no later than 3pm without lights, no later than 7:30 pm with lights.
- Quarter Finals are at the Higher Seed and no later than 3pm without lights, no later than 7:30 pm with lights.
- Semi Finals are at the Summerfield Elementary School Turf Game 1 - 4:00 pm, Game 2 - 6:30 pm

Finals are at the Summerfield Elementary School Turf. (Schedule Listed Above)

ANTICIPATED REVENUES:

Proposed Entry Fees: $100 per team. Make checks payable to $100.00 payable to the Shore Conference of Schools. Mail to **RICH CARROLL AD, MIDDLETOWN NORTH HS, PO BOX 4170 MIDDLETOWN NJ 07748**

Spectator Fees - CHAMPIONSHIP Bracket -Semi Finals - Championship and Coaches Bracket Finals (4 games) - $10 per student and seniors, $15 per Adult - All Day- All games - 1 Fee

- Teams not selected to the SCT Championship Bracket are invited to play in the Shore Conference COACHES Tournament (SCCT). Same Committee seeds SCCT
- SCCT will have the same fees/rules as SCT. Finals only at Neutral Site OR HIGHER SEED - TBD selected by seeding committee.
- The Seeding Committee will be determined by the tournament directors.

- Teams can opt out of either or both tournaments on or before 10/10/26 by emailing Josh Mehl at jmehl@frhsd.com. If you Opt out of the Shore Conference Championship you are not eligible for the Coaches Cup.